



Tesla stops accepting Bitcoin

Tesla has stopped accepting Bitcoin as payment citing environmental reasons. <http://digit.in/jun21-21>



World's first 2nm chip created

IBM developed the first 2nm chip that offers 45% higher CPU performance and 75% lower energy use. <http://digit.in/jun21-22>

Soundcore Liberty Air Pro 2

The trend of more for less continues

Anker is well-known for its array of phone accessories, but it's slowly making its mark in the audio market with its sub-brand, Soundcore. The Liberty Air Pro 2 is a mid-range ANC TWS earphone that faces tough competition from brands such as Oppo, Realme, Jabra, and others. Let's find out if the Liberty Air Pro 2 stands out in this competitive category.

BUILD AND DESIGN

The Soundcore Liberty Air Pro 2 is available in four colours – Onyx Black, Titanium White, Sapphire Blue and Crystal Pink, all of which look pretty elegant. They have a stem-style design and the stem incorporates the touch panel for controls. The earbuds are lightweight and Anker has provided an array of silicone ear tips in the box ranging all the way from XXXS to XL. While these ear tips should cover most ears, the reviewer found it slightly hard to find the perfect fit.

As for the touch panels on the earbuds, they work pretty well as long as you get used to their positioning on the earbud. Moving on to the charging case, it is certainly one of the larger ones on the market. The cover slides to the back and reveals the earbuds within. The sliding mechanism is smooth and pretty unique. The charging case also supports Qi wireless charging, so you can simply plop it down on any compatible charging pad to charge the case.

FEATURES

The Soundcore Liberty Air Pro 2 has ANC at just under 10K, making it an appealing product for those who would like to experience ANC without breaking the bank. There are three pre-tuned modes of ANC on these earbuds – Transport, Indoor, and Outdoor. There's also a Custom mode that allows users to choose the level of ANC.



Active Noise Cancellation on these earbuds is decent but not very impressive. It doesn't come close to the heavyweights in this area such as the Sony WF-1000XM3, but we don't expect them to, due to the price difference. However, the Oppo Enco X that is priced similarly does a more convincing job drowning out ambient sounds.

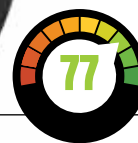
The Soundcore app allows users to customise controls, which is pretty nifty. The app also has an eight-band customisable EQ where users can add different custom sound profiles.

The Soundcore Liberty Air Pro 2 is an extremely feature-laden pair of TWS earbuds. The earbuds come with voice assistant support, IPX4 sweat and water resistance rating, Bluetooth v5.0, in-ear detection, mono mode, and Qi wireless charging support. The buds support SBC and AAC Bluetooth codecs, although it's slightly disappointing to see the lack of support for advanced codecs such as aptX. There's also no multi-point connectivity.

PERFORMANCE

The Soundcore Liberty Air Pro 2 features 11mm dynamic drivers and has a somewhat V-shaped sound signature with plump, punchy bass response and

emphasised treble. The bass response is impactful, well-rounded and full-bodied without being obtrusive to the mids and highs. In *Godzilla* by *Eminem*, there's a low bass rumble in the beginning of the track along with just Eminem's vocals, both of which sound detailed without stepping on each other's toes. However, the slightly overemphasised treble can make some tracks sound harsh. Rock songs with hi-hats sound slightly screechy. However, it isn't something that bothered us too much.



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BATTERY LIFE

The battery life on the Soundcore Liberty Air Pro 2 is pretty decent, but nothing extraordinary. With ANC turned off, you can get up to 26 hours of

total playtime, with 7 hours from the earbuds on a single charge. There's also Fast Charging support where 15 minutes of charging will net you about 3 hours of playtime.

VERDICT

If you're looking for a mid-range TWS with an array of premium features and good tuning, the Soundcore Liberty Air Pro 2 is easy to recommend. It faces tough competition in this segment, especially from the stellar Oppo Enco X, but it manages to stand out due to its hard-hitting but controlled bass and its unique design.

—Dhriti Datta

SPECIFICATIONS

HEADPHONE TYPE: In-Ear | CONNECTIVITY: True Wireless Stereo (TWS) | DRIVER TYPE: Dynamic | DRIVER SIZE (MM): 11 | FREQUENCY RESPONSE: 20Hz-20,000Hz | BLUETOOTH VERSION: 5.0 | BLUETOOTH CODEC SUPPORT: SBC, AAC | BLUETOOTH RANGE: 10m or 33 feet | CHARGING PORT: USB Type-C | CHARGING TIME: 2 hours | BATTERY LIFE (EARBUDS): 5 hours | BATTERY LIFE WITH CASE (TOTAL): 19 hours | Qi WIRELESS CHARGING: Yes

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